

Liberty moves forward

The Liberty Alliance, a global consortium formed to develop online identity standards has unveiled drafts of its Phase 2 specifications—a step that it considers vital in creating a commonly accepted and more trusted way of building and managing identity-based Web services.

“The opportunity for Web services is enormous, and innovation in this space will drive the future of e-commerce,” said Michael Barrett, president of Liberty Alliance. “However, in the meantime,



there are business and technology barriers impeding this innovation and progress. These barriers include the complexity of identity management—a critical component in Web services—as well as the lack of technical standards and the inability for identity management products and services to work together.” The alliance seeks to lower these barriers.

Drafts of security and privacy implementation guidelines as well as a ‘Privacy and Security Best Practices’ document were also introduced today with the Phase 2 draft specifications. These documents highlight global privacy laws and fair information practices, as well as provide implementation guidance for organisations using the Liberty Alliance specifications to build identity-based services.

Outsourcing giants

According to an IDC report, China is still some years away from threatening India’s position as the software outsourcing powerhouse of Asia. “Although there are substantial outsourcing projects in the United States every year, China’s IT companies are weaker than India in IT project management,” said Nicholas Yong, a market analyst with IDC Asia/Pacific. China’s software com-

panies also don’t have the sales channels in the United States that Indian companies do according to IDG. Other factors, that give India an edge,

include its use of English and the quality of its product.

China may be in second place now, but its IT market is still the strongest-growing in the world, and it is also strong in both the export and consumption of software, said the



report. While the US may be India’s big market, Japanese IT firms are the biggest consumers of China-made software, according to IDC.

3G rights-management

IPR Systems, the Sydney-based creator of digital rights enforcement technology, has beaten Microsoft to the coveted crown of protecting content consumed by the next generation multimedia mobile phones.

IPR Systems’ Open Digital Rights Language (ODRL) version 1.1 has been adopted by cell phone manufacturers such as Nokia, Samsung and Sony Ericsson. ODRL gives content creators the power to determine exactly how their

material is used. According to sources, IPR’s four engineers built the Digital Restrictions Management (DRM) language in about two years, before the first version was commercially adopted by Nokia and others.

ODRL is an open standard provided free to developers and phone makers in an attempt to spur wide adoption. The company’s business manager said that it makes money by providing systems that best take advantage of the standard.

quoteworthy

“Red Hat’s main focus has been and will continue to be the enterprise. We’ve had great success in migrating enterprise customers from proprietary UNIX”

Matt Wilson, Manager, Base Operating Systems, at Red Hat, Inc. Red Hat has just publically thrown open its FTP servers that host Red Hat Linux 9, the latest in its stable of the legendary Linux OS.

“We expect to apply Cell to a wide range of applications related to broadband networks, including digital consumer electronics and mobile terminals,”

Takeshi Nakagawa, senior Vice President, Toshiba. Cell is the new processor with a multi-core architecture that will power the PlayStation 3. Toshiba is a partner in the development of Cell and is looking at using the chip in next-generation consumer devices

tomorrow's technology

Liquid cooled systems

Researchers at Purdue University have designed a ‘pumpless’ cooling system that removes six times more heat than existing miniature cooling systems. Researchers thought that bubbles in the liquid coolant might block the circulation of the liquid through the tiny micro-channels.

Instead, they discovered that the liquid flowing through the channels actually forms smaller bubbles that easily pass through them. What’s more, decreasing the diameter of the micro-channels actually increased the cooling efficiency. The most interesting effect is that the

liquid circulates in a self-sustaining flow in a closed loop that carries heat away from a computer chip, that does not need a pump. Computers of tomorrow are expected to generate as much as 300 Watts per square centimeter, this may be the solution to our cooling needs.